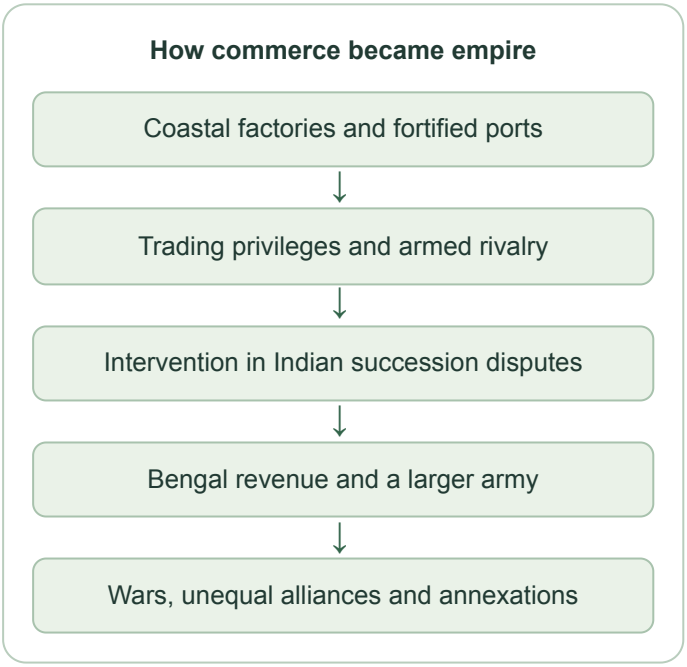
The Advent of Europeans

1. From maritime trade to territorial power

- Europeans entered an existing Indian Ocean trading network. Direct access to spices, textiles and profits, royal rivalry and missionary activity encouraged ocean voyages.
- **Prince Henry** patronised Portuguese exploration; **Bartolomeu Dias rounded the Cape in 1488** after departing in 1487. **Vasco da Gama reached Calicut/Kozhikode in May 1498**, under the **Zamorin**.
- “First Europeans” here means the first of the early modern European maritime powers: Europe–India contacts existed much earlier. A **factory** meant a trading post/warehouse, not necessarily a manufacturing plant.
- Arrival/charter dates differ: **Portuguese arrival 1498; English company 1600; Dutch VOC 1602; Danish company 1616; French company 1664**. English company formation preceded Dutch formation, although Dutch settlement dates differ.



2. Portuguese: naval power and coastal bases

Person / milestone	Remember
Francisco de Almeida, 1505–09	First viceroy; **Blue Water Policy** emphasised naval supremacy, supported by coastal forts
Afonso de Albuquerque, 1509–15	Consolidated territorial bases; **Goa from Bijapur, 1510; Malacca, 1511; Hormuz, 1515**; encouraged Portuguese–Indian marriages; often called the real founder of Portuguese power in the East
Nuno da Cunha	Headquarters shifted **Cochin → Goa, 1530**; distinguish this from Goa's capture
Northern expansion	**Bassein ceded by Gujarat, 1534; Diu fortification agreement, 1535; Daman acquired, 1559**

Person / milestone	Remember
Early bases	Calicut, Cannanore and Cochin; **Cochin fort, 1503**. Other settlements included Bombay/Salsette, San Thome and Hooghly

- **Cartaz:** naval pass regulating shipping, routes and cargo; coercion, seizures and fortified ports supported commercial control. Portuguese supremacy never meant complete control of every Indian Ocean route.
- **1632:** Shah Jahan's forces took Hooghly. **1661:** Bombay included in the Anglo-Portuguese marriage treaty; Charles II married Catherine of Braganza in **1662**. **1668:** Crown leased Bombay to the English Company for **£10 annually**.
- **1663:** Dutch captured Cochin; **1739:** Marathas took Bassein and Salsette. Portuguese enclaves **Goa, Daman and Diu remained until 1961**.
- **Decline:** limited resources, corruption, religious coercion/local resistance, conflict with Asian powers, Dutch/English competition and diversion of resources towards Brazil.
- **Legacy:** Goa printing press **1556**; tobacco, potatoes and other American crops spread through Portuguese and other exchange routes; maritime/military techniques, churches, language and missionary education. **Garcia da Orta's medicinal-plant work, 1563**, contributed to European botanical knowledge; India already possessed medical traditions.
- **Trap:** Albuquerque did not conquer all Ceylon. Do not credit Portuguese with introducing every firearm or military technology to India.

3. Dutch: spice trade and Indian textile bases

- **Cornelis de Houtman, 1596:** reached Java, not India. **VOC established 1602**; combined commercial capital with powers to fortify, make treaties and wage war.
- **Masulipatnam/Machilipatnam, 1605:** earliest Dutch factory in India. **Pulicat, 1610:** important Coromandel headquarters and **Fort Geldria**; headquarters later shifted to **Nagapattinam, 1690**.
- Other centres: Surat, Broach, Cochin, Chinsura (**Fort Gustavus**), Kasimbazar, Patna and Balasore. Trade included textiles, indigo, silk, rice, saltpetre and opium; Indian goods financed Southeast Asian spice commerce.
- **Batavia founded 1619**: do not describe this as conquest of all Java. **Amboyna incident, 1623:** execution of English merchants and others intensified Anglo-Dutch rivalry.
- **Biderra/Bedara/Chinsura, 1759:** English Company defeated Dutch forces in Bengal. Dutch trading possessions did not disappear immediately; final transfers followed later agreements.
- **PYQ distinction:** earliest overall = **Masulipatnam**; earliest among Surat/Pulicat/Cochin/Kasimbazar = **Pulicat**. Coromandel grants were linked to Vijayanagara successors/local rulers, not the Gajapatis.

4. English Company: charter, factories and presidencies

Date	Event / examination link
31 December 1600	Elizabeth I's charter; initial **15-year** trading monopoly; renewed under James I in **1609**
1608–09	William Hawkins arrived at Surat on *Hector*, then visited **Jahangir's** court; Portuguese opposition obstructed concessions
1611	First English factory in South India at **Masulipatnam**
1612 → 1613	**Thomas Best at Swally** defeated Portuguese shipping → permission for Surat factory

Date	Event / examination link
1615–19	**Thomas Roe**, James I's ambassador, negotiated at Jahangir's court; trading links at Agra, Ahmedabad and Broach
1632 / 1633	Golconda's **Golden Farman** / eastern factories at **Hariharpur and Balasore, Odisha**
1639 → 1640	**Francis Day and Andrew Cogan**, Madras land grant from Damarla Venkatadri Nayak under the Vijayanagara/Chandragiri authority → **Fort St George**, first English fort in India
1668	Bombay transferred from Crown to Company
1690 → 1698	Charnock's Sutanuti settlement → zamindari rights over **Sutanuti, Kalikata and Gobindapur**; distinguish settlement from later land rights
Around 1700	Fort William and Bengal presidency developed; Calcutta was not an uninhabited city created by one man

Three presidency centres: Madras—Fort St George; Bombay—western base; Calcutta—Fort William.

Farrukhsiyar's farman, 1717

- **John Surman's embassy, 1715**, included physician **William Hamilton**; Surman was the envoy, not Governor of Calcutta.
- Farmans confirmed Company privileges: Bengal duty concessions for **₹3,000 annually**, additional village-rental rights around Calcutta; Surat arrangement for **₹10,000 annually**; southern trading/rental concessions. Often called the Company's **"Magna Carta"**.
- **Dastak = duty-free transit pass** for entitled **Company goods**. Servants used privileges to evade duties on **private trade**, depriving the Nawab of revenue and disadvantaging Indian traders.
- Do not read a Company exemption as a legal exemption for every English trader or every private cargo.

5. Danes and French

Power	Establishment / bases	Outcome
Danish	Company **1616**; **Tranquebar/Tharangambadi 1620**; **Serampore/Frederiksnagore 1755**, Bengal	Trade, missionary printing and education; Tranquebar/Serampore sold to British **1845**
French	Company **1664**, **Colbert under Louis XIV**; **Caron—Surat 1668; Marcara—Masulipatnam 1669**	Latest arrival among the four powers in the standard PYQ: Portuguese, Dutch, English, French
French centres	**Pondicherry 1673–74**, developed by François Martin, **Fort Louis**; Chandernagore, Mahe, Karaikal, Yanam; links with Balasore/Kasimbazar	**Dupleix became governor 1742**; territorial ambitions challenged English power

Pondicherry trap: earlier Portuguese and Dutch presence preceded the durable French settlement. The Dutch seized it in **1693**, and the English occupied it in **1761**; therefore "English never occupied Pondicherry" is false.

6. Carnatic Wars: European rivalry meets Indian politics

Carnatic here refers broadly to the south-eastern/Coromandel political region, not simply present-day Karnataka.

War	Trigger and key events	Settlement / significance
First, 1746–48	Extension of the **War of Austrian Succession, 1740–48**. English seizures of French shipping; **La Bourdonnais captured Madras, 1746**. Nawab **Anwar-ud-din's** force under **Mahfuz Khan** defeated by French at **Adyar/St Thome, 1746**	**Aix-la-Chapelle, 1748:** Madras restored to English; Louisbourg restored to France. Small disciplined European-led forces could defeat larger local forces in particular circumstances
Second, 1749–54	Succession disputes after Nizam-ul-Mulk's death **1748**. French backed **Muzaffar Jang—Hyderabad; Chanda Sahib—Carnatic**. English backed **Nasir Jang; Muhammad Ali**. **Ambur, 1749:** Anwar-ud-din killed; Muhammad Ali retreated to Trichinopoly	**Clive's Arcot campaign, 1751**, diverted pressure from Trichinopoly; Arni and Kaveripak followed. Chanda Sahib killed **1752**; Dupleix recalled **1754**; **Godeheu's Pondicherry agreement, 1754** curtailed intervention
Third, 1756–63	Part of **Seven Years' War**. **Count de Lally** captured Fort St David **1758**, recalled Bussy from Hyderabad; failed siege of Madras **1758–59**. **Eyre Coote defeated Lally at Wandiwash, 1760**; Pondicherry fell **1761**	**Paris, 1763:** French trading settlements restored subject to restrictions; ambitions for major territorial dominance broken

- Hyderabad sequence: **Nasir Jang killed 1750 → Muzaffar Jang briefly succeeded → Salabat Jang supported by Bussy**. Northern Circars helped fund French forces before English gains.
- **Why English prevailed:** sea power/reinforcements, multiple commercial bases, stronger finance, Bengal resources after Plassey, and effective leadership/alliances. French internal disagreement, naval weakness and competing European commitments hurt their cause.
- Both companies relied on state authority and Indian troops/allies. Avoid “private English versus purely state French” as a complete explanation; French enclaves survived **1763**.

7. Bengal: Plassey, Buxar and diwani

From commercial privilege to conflict

- Bengal's fertile agriculture, textiles, silk, saltpetre and trade made it a rich base. Nawab sequence: **Murshid Quli Khan → Shuja-ud-din → Sarfaraz Khan → Alivardi Khan → Siraj-ud-Daulah**.
- **Siraj succeeded Alivardi in 1756**; conflicts involved unauthorised fortifications, abuse of dastaks and English shelter to Krishna Ballabh.
- Court rivals included **Ghaseti Begum**, **Shaukat Jang** and **Mir Jafar**. Ghaseti was **Alivardi's daughter**, not his widow.
- Siraj captured Kasimbazar and **Fort William, June 1756**. Prisoner deaths associated with the **“Black Hole”** account remain contested in number and detail; do not treat Holwell's figures as settled facts.
- English survivors withdrew to Fulta; **Clive and Admiral Watson recovered Calcutta early in 1757**. Company officials then conspired with Mir Jafar, Jagat Seth and other court/financial interests.

Turning point	What happened	Why it mattered
Plassey, 23 June 1757	**Clive vs Siraj**; Mir Jafar and other commanders withheld effective support. Mir Madan/Mohan Lal resisted; Siraj later killed under Miran's orders	Mir Jafar installed; Company gained money, influence and **24 Parganas** zamindari. Conspiracy and defections were decisive; conquest of India was not completed
Mir Jafar → Mir Qasim, 1760	Financial demands exhausted Mir Jafar; Company installed his son-in-law. Mir Qasim ceded **Burdwan, Midnapore, Chittagong**	He sought effective independence, reformed revenue/army, shifted capital **Murshidabad → Munger**, established gun manufacture
Dastak confrontation, 1763	Mir Qasim abolished internal duties to place Indian merchants on equal terms; Company resisted. War followed; Mir Jafar restored	Conflict concerned commercial privilege and sovereign authority, not only personalities
Buxar, 22 October 1764	Company army under **Hector Munro** defeated forces of **Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daulah of Awadh and Shah Alam II**	Confirmed military advantage beyond the Plassey conspiracy; opened the way for an imperial revenue grant
Allahabad settlement, 1765	**Shah Alam II granted diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa**; annual payment **₹26 lakh**. Emperor received Kara/Allahabad; Shuja paid **₹50 lakh** indemnity and retained Awadh	Legal revenue authority reinforced effective power; Awadh kept as buffer. “Orissa” in the grant did not mean all present-day Odisha was already occupied

After Mir Jafar's death in **1765**, **Najm-ud-Daulah** became the nominal Nawab. Company control over appointments, finance and military power hollowed out the nizamat.

Dual Government, 1765–72



- **Diwani:** revenue and civil administration/justice; **nizamat:** executive authority, policing and criminal justice. **Robert Clive** established the dual arrangement.
- Company initially exercised diwani **through Indian deputies**, not a fully developed direct British collectorate from the first day. **Muhammad Reza Khan** combined deputy roles in Bengal; **Shitab Rai** handled Bihar revenue.
- Company and servants extracted revenue, forced unfavourable trading terms and financed exports/wars from Indian resources, reducing the need for bullion imports.
- **Bengal famine, 1770:** crop failure interacted with extraction and administrative neglect. Mortality was catastrophic; the often quoted **one-third** is a historical estimate, not a secure census count.
- **Plassey vs Buxar:** political foothold and resources **vs** decisive regional military victory leading to formal diwani. Neither made later resistance impossible.

8. Mysore: four wars, three treaties

- **Wodeyar** Mysore grew increasingly independent amid Vijayanagara's decline after **Talikota, 1565**; the dynasty predated that battle.
- **Hyder Ali** strengthened army/artillery with European expertise, established an arms factory at **Dindigul** and controlled valuable Malabar trade. **Tipu Sultan** continued military and administrative reform and sought foreign alliances.

War / Company leadership	Trigger and course	Outcome
First, 1767–69	British, Nizam and Marathas initially opposed Hyder; he used diplomacy to break the coalition and advanced towards Madras	**Madras, 1769:** mutual restoration; defensive assistance if attacked by a third party
Second, 1780–84; Warren Hastings	British failed to aid Hyder against Marathas; seizure of French **Mahe, 1779**, and British troop movements worsened relations. **Baillie defeated at Pollilur, 1780**; Hyder took Arcot; **Coote won Porto Novo, 1781**	Hyder died **1782**; Tipu continued. **Mangalore, 1784:** mutual restoration of territory and prisoners; no decisive British territorial victory
Third, 1790–92; Cornwallis	Tipu's attack on British ally **Travancore, 1789–90**; Company allied with Nizam and Marathas. Medows' initial campaign; Cornwallis captured **Bangalore, 1791**; supplies/Maratha help enabled renewed siege in **1792**	**Seringapatam, 1792:** about **half Tipu's territory** divided among allies; **₹3.3 crore** indemnity; **two sons as hostages** pending payment; prisoners released
Fourth, 1799; Lord Wellesley	Tipu's French contacts and rejection of British demands; Hyderabad's French corps disbanded under its **1798 alliance**. **George Harris** led main Madras army; **Stuart** advanced from west; Arthur Wellesley held a subordinate command	**Seringapatam fell, 4 May 1799**; Tipu killed; territory partitioned; reduced Wodeyar state under subsidiary alliance

- Third-war Company gains: **Malabar, Baramahal and Dindigul**; Nizam/Marathas also gained. **Coorg** was detached from Tipu and placed under its Raja with Company protection; do not call every detached area an immediate British district.
- Tipu sent envoys towards Ottoman Turkey (**1786** mission) and France; a **French revolutionary/Jacobin association and Tree of Liberty at Seringapatam** symbolised the connection. Such contacts alarmed Wellesley but did not deliver a French army in 1799.
- After **1799**: **Krishnaraja Wodeyar III** installed; **Purnaiya** became diwan. Company retained strategic regions including Canara, Coimbatore, Wayanad and Seringapatam; Nizam received a share; Tipu's family sent to Vellore.

- **1831:** Bentinck's government assumed Mysore administration on alleged misgovernment; **1881:** restored under **Ripon**. British paramountcy remained.
- **Memory: Madras—Mangalore—Seringapatam—Tipu's death**. **Hostages = Third War; death = Fourth War**. **Lord Wellesley** was Governor-General; **Arthur Wellesley** was the soldier.

9. Marathas: three wars and a divided confederacy

Chiefs: Peshwa—Poona; Scindia—Gwalior; Holkar—Indore; Bhonsle—Nagpur; Gaekwad—Baroda. The Peshwa's nominal leadership coexisted with independent interests and armies.

First Anglo-Maratha War, 1775–82: Warren Hastings

- **Madhav Rao I died 1772 → Narayan Rao succeeded, murdered 1773 → Raghunath Rao claimed power → Nana Phadnavis and other chiefs supported infant Madhav Rao II**.
- **Surat, 1775:** Bombay authorities promised Raghunath Rao military support for Salsette/Bassein and revenue concessions. Calcutta Council opposed the arrangement; **Colonel Upton** negotiated **Purandar, 1776**: recognise infant Peshwa, withdraw support to Raghunath Rao; Company retained Salsette and specified revenue advantages.
- Renewed intervention led to **Talegaon/Wadgaon, January 1779**: Maratha forces used terrain, supply denial and mobile attacks to force Bombay army's surrender. **Mahadji Scindia** was prominent. The source's **1776** date is wrong.
- **Wadgaon convention, 1779:** demanded reversal of Company territorial gains; Hastings rejected it. **Goddard captured Ahmedabad and Bassein, 1780; Popham took Gwalior, 1780**, not 1781.
- **Salbai, 1782:** settlement with Scindia; **Madhav Rao II recognised**, Raghunath Rao pensioned, most gains restored, English retained **Salsette**. Approximately twenty years of peace followed.
- **Evaluation:** Marathas preserved independence in the short term; Company escaped a difficult two-front war and gained freedom to concentrate on Mysore. Maratha participation against Mysore varied: they joined the Third War alliance but were neutral in the Fourth.

Second Anglo-Maratha War, 1803–05: Lord Wellesley

- **Nana Phadnavis died 1800**; Peshwa–Scindia–Holkar rivalry intensified. **Vithoji Holkar killed 1801**; **Yashwant Rao Holkar defeated Peshwa/Scindia at Poona, 1802**.
- Peshwa **Baji Rao II** fled and signed **Bassein, 31 December 1802**: subsidiary force, territory yielding **₹26 lakh** for upkeep, British resident, restrictions on diplomacy and European employment. Restored by British troops in **1803**.
- **Significance:** British foothold at Poona and strategic deployment across Deccan; nominal confederacy head became dependent. Other Maratha chiefs did **not** become automatically bound by his treaty.

Campaign	Result / treaty
Arthur Wellesley, 1803	Ahmednagar captured; Scindia/Bhonsle defeated at **Assaye** and **Argaon**
Bhonsle—Deogaon, 1803	Territorial concessions including **Cuttack**; growing Company influence
Lake in the north, 1803	Aligarh, Delhi, Agra and **Laswari**; Shah Alam II came under British protection
Scindia—Surji-Arjungaon, 1803	Lost extensive territories and accepted restrictions; subsidiary arrangements followed
Holkar, 1804–05	Continued resistance; British failures at **Bharatpur** exposed limits. Costly expansion helped bring Wellesley's recall

Campaign	Result / treaty
Rajpurghat, December 1805	Peace with Holkar; much territory restored. Do not use **1806** as the treaty year

Pindaris and Third Anglo-Maratha War, 1817–18: Lord Hastings

- **Pindaris:** mobile plundering bands, associated with irregular military service; mixed social/religious backgrounds. Leaders **Karim Khan, Wasil Muhammad, Chitu**. Demobilisation and warfare enlarged their role; they were not a single caste or regular salaried army.
- Raids: **Mirzapur/Shahabad 1812; Nizam's territories 1815; Northern Circars 1816**. Preparations in **1816** led to the main suppression campaign **1817–18**, overlapping the Maratha war.
- Karim Khan surrendered and received an estate; Wasil Muhammad died in captivity; Chitu's reported death by tiger belongs to later accounts. British pressure for anti-Pindari cooperation also tightened control over Maratha chiefs.
- **Scindia's Gwalior treaty, 1817**, constrained him; he stayed out of the principal anti-British fighting. Do not list him as a leading battlefield opponent alongside the Peshwa.

Chief / event	Outcome
Baji Rao II—Kirkee/Khadki, November 1817	Attack on Poona Residency defeated; later surrender; Peshwaship abolished **1818**, pensioned at **Bithur**
Appa Sahib Bhonsle—Sitabuldi, November 1817	Nagpur resistance defeated
Holkar—Mahidpur, 21 December 1817	Defeated; **Mandsaur treaty, 1818**, imposed dependence. Battle was at **Mahidpur, not Baroda**
Settlement 1818	Satara created for **Pratap Singh**, Shivaji's descendant, under British dependence; Bombay territories expanded; Rajput states accepted British protection

Why Marathas lost: confederate rivalries, leadership instability, financial/logistical weakness, uneven coordination and Company diplomacy. Some Maratha armies had modern European-trained infantry/artillery: defeat cannot be explained as “old weapons versus modern weapons” alone. **1818 established Company paramountcy over much of India; Punjab/Sindh and several other regions were not yet annexed.**

10. Sindh: commerce, frontier strategy and annexation

- Indus navigation and access to Afghanistan/Persia attracted Company interest. Initial **Thatta factory, 1758–75**, belonged to the Kalhora phase; later **Talpur Amirs**, of Baluch origin, ruled Sindh.
- **Tilsit, 1807**, heightened British fears of Franco-Russian cooperation. **Minto's missions: Metcalfe—Lahore; Elphinstone—Kabul; Malcolm—Persia; Hankey Smith—Sindh**. Do not treat an invasion of India as an executed treaty programme.

Date	Step towards control
1809	Friendship treaty with Amirs; exclusion of French influence; territorial assurances
1820	Renewed arrangements, including exclusion of Americans and frontier issues
1831 / 1832	**Alexander Burnes** explored Indus navigation / **Henry Pottinger** secured commercial navigation treaty

Date	Step towards control
1838–39	Afghan expedition and Sikh pressure used to secure British residence, military transit, payments and a subsidiary arrangement
1839–42	First Anglo-Afghan War; British reverses supplied a wider context for renewed expansion
1842–43	Under **Ellenborough**, **Charles Napier** combined political/military authority; destruction of **Imamgarh** and new demands intensified conflict
1843	**Miani** and **Dubba/Dabo**, Napier defeated Talpur forces, including **Sher Muhammad**; Sindh annexed; Napier became governor

Evaluation: Indus trade, strategic access and restoration of imperial prestige interacted with coercive treaty changes. Claims of unavoidable defensive conquest should be assessed against earlier guarantees to the Amirs. The famous **"Peccavi / I have sinned"** is a satirical pun later associated with Napier, not a verified telegram he sent.

11. Punjab: buffer state to annexation

- **Ranjit Singh** built a strong Sikh state and balanced frontier diplomacy; **Bentinck met him at Ropar, 1831**. Indus/Sutlej commercial arrangements followed in the early 1830s.
- **Tripartite Treaty, 1838:** Company, Ranjit Singh and **Shah Shuja**, in the context of the Afghan intervention.
- Ranjit's death **1839** led to court/army struggles. **Kharak Singh and Nau Nihal Singh died 1840; Sher Singh assassinated 1843**; causes of the first two deaths are contested, not all simply proven murders.
- Child **Duleep/Dalip Singh** succeeded **1843**, with **Rani Jindan** as regent. Wazir **Hira Singh killed 1844; Jawahar Singh killed 1845**. Khalsa army influence grew as British frontier preparations increased mistrust.

First Anglo-Sikh War, 1845–46: Hardinge / Gough

Battle	Correct association
Mudki and Ferozeshah, December 1845	British under **Hugh Gough**, with Governor-General **Hardinge**; Sikh commanders included Lal Singh/Tej Singh
Baddowal, January 1846	**Ranjodh Singh Majithia** checked **Harry Smith**; a Sikh success, not the British victory printed in the source
Aliwal, January 1846	**Harry Smith** defeated Sikh forces
Sobraon, February 1846	**Gough's** decisive victory; not Harry Smith's sole command; British advanced to Lahore

- **Lahore treaty, March 1846:** Jalandhar Doab ceded, **₹1.5 crore** indemnity imposed, army reduced, Duleep retained under British influence; Henry Lawrence became Resident.
- Inability to pay the full indemnity led to cession of hill territories. **Separate Amritsar treaty, March 1846:** Kashmir transferred to **Gulab Singh** for **₹75 lakh**, not ₹50 lakh.
- **Bhairowal, December 1846:** regency council of **eight Sikh chiefs** under British Resident; Jindan excluded from regency; occupation expenses charged to Punjab. Effective British control increased without immediate annexation.

Second Anglo-Sikh War, 1848–49: Dalhousie / Gough

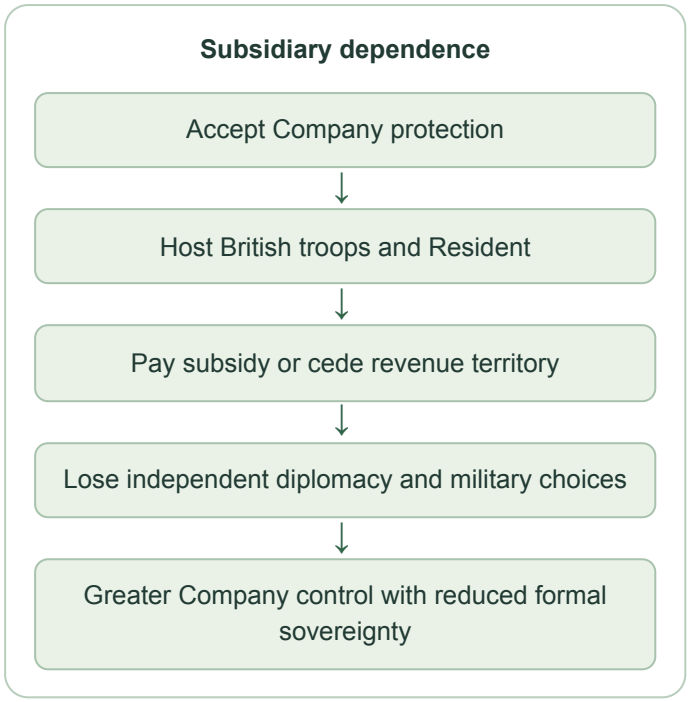
- Multan uprising under **Mulraj**, with broader resistance involving **Chattar Singh Attariwala and Sher Singh**, developed into war. Resentment of British interference and Jindan's treatment contributed.
- **Ramnagar, November 1848 → Chillianwala, January 1849:** stiff resistance and heavy losses; **Gujrat, February 1849:** Gough's decisive victory; surrender followed.
- **29 March 1849: Punjab annexed** under **Dalhousie**. Duleep pensioned; went to Britain later, **1854**, not immediately with Jindan in 1849.
- **Board of Administration: Henry Lawrence, John Lawrence, Charles Mansel**. **1853:** Board abolished; **John Lawrence became Chief Commissioner**. **John Lawrence briefly became the first Lieutenant-Governor in January 1859; Robert Montgomery succeeded him in February 1859**.
- **Mains argument:** succession instability mattered, but so did the north-west frontier strategy, unequal treaties, Company intervention and Dalhousie's annexation policy. Heavy British casualties disprove an effortless or inevitable conquest.

12. Instruments of expansion: distinguish the policies

Policy	Mechanism	Effect / example
Ring Fence	Defend Company frontiers through buffer states; associated with **Warren Hastings**	Awadh shielded Bengal from north/western threats; protection expenses borne by allied rulers
Subsidiary Alliance	Earlier precedents included Dupleix's paid troops; **Wellesley, 1798–1805**, systematised dependence	British troops/Resident within state; ruler paid cash or ceded revenue territory, restricted foreign relations and European employment; Company promised protection
Doctrine of Lapse	**Dalhousie, 1848–56**, aggressively applied earlier claims over political succession in dependent states	Without a recognised natural male successor, Company could refuse adopted heir's political succession and annex; **private adoption/inheritance was not simply banned**
Alleged misgovernment	Separate pretext for takeover	**Awadh, 1856**, under Wajid Ali Shah; **not lapse**. Mysore administration taken over in **1831**, also distinct from lapse

Subsidiary Alliance: terms and consequences

- Permanent Company troops maintained by the protected ruler; **Resident** stationed at court. War, peace and external alliances required British approval; employment of other Europeans restricted.
- Nominal promise of internal non-interference coexisted with practical interference. Local military strength declined; subsidy arrears could trigger territorial cessions; Company deployed larger armies at Indian states' expense.
- Important stages: **Hyderabad 1798; Mysore 1799; Awadh 1801; Peshwa—Bassein 1802; Scindia arrangements 1803–04; Holkar/Rajput settlements 1817–18**. Tanjore's **1799** arrangement transferred administration; avoid treating every treaty as identical.



Lapse: high-yield dates

- **Satara 1848; Jaitpur and Sambalpur 1849; Jhansi and Nagpur 1854**. Their rulers' deaths/adoption disputes may precede the final annexation year.
- **Awadh 1856 = alleged misgovernment**, not absence of an heir. **Punjab 1849 = military conquest**, not lapse. **Sindh 1843 = Napier's conquest**.
- Annexations disrupted courts, armies, pensions, patronage and revenue arrangements, contributing to grievances before **1857**.

13. Why Company power expanded

- **Political:** regional rivalries/succession disputes; Company isolated opponents through treaties, Residents and alliances. Avoid judging eighteenth-century rulers by a fully developed modern national identity.
- **Military:** disciplined Indian sepoy forces, regular pay, training, artillery, naval support and coordinated command; Indian opponents also possessed sophisticated forces and won significant engagements.
- **Fiscal and logistical:** commercial credit, bankers, coastal supply bases, Bengal revenue, and integration of civil/military administration sustained campaigns.
- **Leadership and diplomacy:** Clive, Hastings, Cornwallis, Wellesley, Coote and Lake exploited opportunities; Hyder, Tipu, Nana Phadnavis, Scindia and Holkar offered substantial resistance.
- **Global context:** British shipping, finance and state support reinforced Company power. **Industrial Revolution began in eighteenth-century Britain**, not the sixteenth century; early victories cannot all be attributed to industrial weapons.
- **Assessment:** trade, revenue, war and diplomacy reinforced one another. Conquest was uneven and contingent, with Indian soldiers, financiers and allies central to the outcome.

14. PYQ recall and answer plans

Full statements/options are retained in the common subject PYQ files. Four questions printed as **2008** in the chapter belong to **2007**; the misgovernance question's option **(c) is Nagpur**, not “French”.

Year / theme	Answer / revision reason
2022: European grants	**(b), 2 and 3 only**: Goa–Bijapur and Madras–Vijayanagara correct; Dutch–Gajapati false
2021: Broach, Chicacole, Trichinopoly	**(a), Broach only**, in first quarter of seventeenth century
2021: Chengiz / Taimur / da Gama	**(a), 1 only**: Chengiz reached Indus during Iltutmish; Timur's invasion belongs to **1398**, not Muhammad bin Tughluq; da Gama's **1498** arrival postdates Deva Raya II
2018: Bengal exports	**(d): cotton, silk, saltpetre, opium**
2010: Pondicherry	**(a), 1 only**; English occupied it and French were not the second European presence
2007: misgovernance / latest arrival / first fort	**Awadh (a) / French (c) / Fort St George (b)**
2007: Clive and Bentinck	**(b), 2 only**: **Warren Hastings**, not Clive, first Governor-General of Bengal; **Bentinck** first Governor-General of India under Charter Act **1833**
2004: Panipat, Tipu, Plassey statements	**(b), 3 only**. Panipat **1761**: Abdali defeated Marathas; Ibrahim Lodi defeated by Babur **1526**. Tipu died **1799**
2004: war-date pairs	**(d), 2 and 3**: Third Mysore **1790–92**, First Burmese **1824–26**; **1767–69** = First Mysore, **1845–46** = First Sikh
2003: European entry / Dutch factory	**(a)** incorrect Goa **1499** claim: correct **1510**; **(b) Pulicat** earliest among listed locations

2015 History Optional: Punjab, about 150 words

Question: Critically examine: “Annexation of Punjab was part of a broad north-west frontier policy set in motion after the exit of Maharaja Ranjit Singh.”

Answer plan: define strategic concern (Afghanistan, routes, buffer) → Ranjit's death and court instability → British frontier mobilisation and First War → Lahore/Bhairowal made protection into intervention → Multan rising, Second War and annexation → evaluate strategy alongside local conflict, Company agency and annexationism. Avoid presenting inevitable conquest as the only possible outcome.

2014 History Optional: Plassey, about 150 words

Question: Critically examine: “Plassey did not complete the British conquest of India. Had the English been convincingly defeated in any subsequent battle in India, then the battle of Plassey would have remained as a minor episode in the history of India.”

Answer plan: Plassey secured a dependent Nawab, resources and foothold → Buxar/diwani consolidated regional power → Mysore and Maratha wars required further victories; Sikh resistance continued into 1849 → recognise Bengal finance as a durable advantage while explaining that one victory did not predetermine every later result.

Practice recall

- **War → treaty:** Carnatic **Aix-la-Chapelle / Pondicherry / Paris**; Mysore **Madras / Mangalore / Seringapatam / 1799 defeat**; First Maratha **Salbai**; Second Maratha **Deogaon, Surji-Arjungaon, Rajpurghat**.
- **Governor-General:** Clive—Dual Government; Warren Hastings—First Maratha/Second Mysore; Cornwallis—Third Mysore; Wellesley—Fourth Mysore/Second Maratha; Lord Hastings—Third Maratha; Ellenborough—Sindh; Hardinge—First Sikh; Dalhousie—Second Sikh.

- **Early successes, limited gains:** Hyder's **1769** treaty did not ensure British help; Marathas' **1779** success did not prevent later Company recovery. Explain coalition breakdown, uneven resources, renewed diplomacy and changed strategic circumstances.
- **Sequence by beginning:** Carnatic wars **1746** → Plassey **1757** → First Mysore **1767** → First Maratha **1775**. Carnatic wars overlapped Plassey: do not imply all ended before 1757.

References for checking disputed details

- Supplied chapter; compare Modern History: European background and settlements.
- Goa Government: Portuguese conquest from Bijapur; Diu administration: fortification agreement; Puducherry Government: settlement history.
- National Museum of Denmark: Serampore; Banglapedia: Farrukhsiyar's farman.
- Treaty collection: Seringapatam indemnity; 1799 dispatch: Harris' command; National Army Museum: Gwalior, 1780.
- National Army Museum: First Sikh War and Second Sikh War; NCERT: From Trade to Territory.
- Punjab Raj Bhavan: official list of pre-Independence heads; Choudhury: archival study of Tipu's 1786 Ottoman embassy.